

The Final Ledger

Reconstructing the Historical and Genetic Reality of Asa Hall (1758–1841)

2026 Revision and Corroboration of the 2000 Hall Lineage Study

Prepared by Roderick A. Hall

July 19, 2026

Abstract

For decades, institutional genealogical records incorrectly linked the pioneer Asa Hall of Montgomery County, Virginia, to an aristocratic colonial lineage out of Wallingford, Connecticut. That connection was based on the volatile methodology of surname-matching across distinct regional archives, amplified by the 1970 DAR publication *A Slice of History: A Story of a Hall Family of America*.

This ledger systematically dismantles that folklore by combining four independent lines of evidence:

1. **Genetic genealogy** — Y-DNA haplogroup analysis of direct male-line descendants.
2. **Scholarly lineage research** — the synthesis of Wanda Ware DeGidio on the Rhode Island Hall line.
3. **Primary land records** — Virginia state land grants demonstrating independent frontier land tenure.
4. **Probate evidence** — the 1841 estate appraisal and dower allotment, which provide the material reality of Asa Hall's life.

The result is an evidence-based biography of a Revolutionary War veteran and Appalachian pioneer whose legacy has been obscured by repeated archival conflations.

Preface: The 2000 Foundation

This report builds directly upon the original Hall lineage study completed in 2000. That earlier work first identified the inconsistencies in existing DAR narratives and set the critical research questions that this document now resolves.

The 2000 manuscript established the documentary trail pointing away from the Wallingford, Connecticut line. What was missing at that time was the genetic corroboration and the broader migration context provided by modern DNA testing and by DeGidio's Rhode Island research. This 2026 revision brings those missing pillars to the original foundation.

Section I: The Foundation of Empirical Proof — Y-DNA Analysis

For decades, institutional lineage records incorrectly linked the pioneer Asa Hall of Montgomery County to a prominent colonial lineage out of Wallingford, Connecticut. This connection was predicated entirely on the highly volatile methodology of surname-matching across distinct regional archives. Modern genetic genealogy has provided an empirical resolution to this error.

Paternal lineages from the Connecticut-based Hall families consistently exhibit the **R-M269 haplogroup**, a genetic marker highly prevalent across Western Europe and common among New

England settlers. Conversely, deep-clade Y-DNA testing of direct, documented male-line descendants of the Southwest Virginia Hall family reveals a distinct classification within **Haplogroup G-M201** (specifically the rare G2a subgroup).

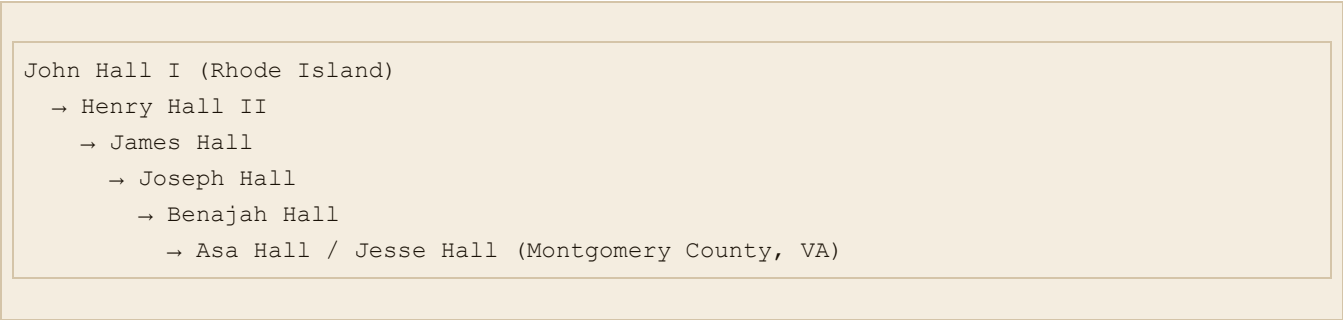
Haplogroup G2a is an exceptionally rare lineage in Northern Europe, often associated with isolated mountainous pockets of Southern Europe, ancient Anatolian migrations, and high-status early European archaeological remains—such as the Merovingian-period warrior burials at Ergolding. Because mutations defining a haplogroup remain constant over hundreds of generations, the absolute divergence between the R-M269 lineage of New England and the G-M201 lineage of the Southwest Virginia frontier establishes a biological barrier.

Conclusion: It is genetically impossible for the Montgomery County pioneer to share a recent paternal line with the Connecticut estate families.

Section II: The Rhode Island to New York Migration — The DeGidio Synthesis

With the Connecticut lineage disproven by genetic evidence, the definitive paper-trail and migration framework is provided by the scholarly research of **Wanda Ware DeGidio**. Her work correctly aligns the Southwest Virginia branch with the historical movements of the John Hall of Rhode Island line, matching both the geographical progression and the rare G2a genetic signature.

The true paternal lineage develops across seven generations:



While the family’s earliest American roots are in Rhode Island, mid-eighteenth-century land movements saw Benajah Hall shift his family northward and westward into the colonial borders of New York. This New York residency provides the crucial context for Asa Hall's Revolutionary War service, correcting institutional records that conflated him with soldiers from the Connecticut Line or with the 1777 military census of Hopkinton, Rhode Island.

As documented in his congressional pension file granted on June 17, 1833, Asa Hall enlisted in New York. His military records detail the following service:

- **March 1776 – December 1776:** Served as a private in the New York Regiment under Captain Nathan Pierce, fighting at the Battle of Long Island and the Battle of White Plains.
- **July 1, 1777 – December 1777:** Enlisted under Captain John Salisbury of New York, marching northward to participate in the campaign that culminated in the capture of British General John Burgoyne at Saratoga.

This New York military service aligns with the movements of Benajah Hall's sons, anchoring Asa and his brother Jesse in the New York theater of war prior to their southward migration.

Reference: DeGidio, Wanda Ware. *Lineage of the Descendants of John Hall of Rhode Island*. Available at www.hallfamilyname.com.

Section III: Frontier Land Tenure and Settler Archives in the Roanoke Valley

Following the Revolutionary War, the economic focus of the brothers shifted toward the open lands of the southern frontier. Around 1790, Asa and Jesse Hall migrated from New York to the Roanoke Valley of Virginia. Rather than operating as transient woodsmen or speculative hunters, the brothers immediately engaged the formal legal frameworks of the Commonwealth of Virginia to establish permanent landholdings along the North Fork of the Roanoke River.

The continuous property consolidation achieved by Asa Hall is preserved across sequential land grants issued by successive Virginia governors:

150-Acre Patent — October 17, 1803

- **Issued by:** Governor John Page
- **Authority:** Land Office Treasury Warrant No. 3045, dated December 11, 1800
- **Location:** Montgomery County, "on the waters of Kearnes run a branch of the north fork of Roanoke"

25-Acre Patent — April 1, 1815

- **Issued by:** Governor Wilson Cary Nicholas
- **Authority:** Land Office Exchange Treasury Warrant No. 1990, dated January 2, 1809
- **Location:** "In the forks of Kenny a branch of the north fork of Roanoke"
- **Notable detail:** The survey locates the boundary "beginning at two black oaks on a hill side just above his house on a line of his patented land."

These entries serve as definitive proof of long-term stability. The legal text explicitly tethers Asa Hall's physical residence—"his house"—to his expanding, contiguous acreage on Kearnes Run and Kenny

Creek. They highlight an organized life centered around agricultural development and permanent community building.

Section IV: Probate and the Material Reality of Law vs. Lore

The ultimate validation of a historical life rests in the probate records filed upon its conclusion. The estate files of Asa Hall, processed through the Montgomery County Court in the spring of 1841 (Will Book 6, Pages 325 & 326), provide an unvarnished view of his material existence. This record serves as the final rebuttal to the aristocratic myths of inherited New England fortunes.

On March 6, 1841, court-appointed appraisers John Birchfield, William Sublet, and Thomas Jewel conducted an inventory of the estate's personal property. The ledger reflects the utilitarian, self-sufficient lifestyle of an established Appalachian farmer:

- **Agricultural equipment & livestock:** One cow (\$6.00), one calf (\$2.00), a spade and scythe (\$2.00), a foot adz (\$0.50), an ax (\$0.75), and a lot of old iron (\$0.50).
- **Domestic textiles & production:** One little spinning wheel (\$3.50), one big spinning wheel (\$0.25), a "trampling sac," and multiple beds with "riggin" and bedsteads.
- **Household goods:** A cupboard (\$10.00), an old clock (\$9.00), a looking glass (\$0.50), kitchen implements, and one gun (\$6.00).
- **Intellectual & spiritual life:** "Two books westey summond" (likely Methodist sermons of John Wesley) and "one lot of books," indicating a literate household engaged with frontier religious movements.

On April 8, 1841, the court completed the dower allotment for the widow, Mary Hall. The description relies on permanent landscape features and immediate neighbors:

"Beginning at the line of James Grahams making a corner on two pices at said Graham lines on a ridge from there in a straight line to a walnut at the yard fence; from thence with the branch to John Jewels line..."

This legal description fixes Asa Hall's residence within a known community of named neighbors, further grounding his life in verifiable local records.

Summary of the Historical Correction

Category	Institutional Folklore (1970 DAR Narrative)	Documented Historical Reality (The Final Ledger)
Paternal Ancestry	Derived from an aristocratic Wallingford, Connecticut line.	Traced to John Hall of Rhode Island via Benajah Hall of New York.
Y-DNA Haplogroup	R-M269 (Standard Western European / New England)	G-M201 / G2a (Rare ancient European / Appalachian marker)
Revolutionary Service	Conflated with Connecticut Continental Line units.	New York Regiments (Captains Pierce and Salisbury); fought at Long Island, White Plains, and Saratoga.
Frontier Character	Speculative hunter / undocumented scout.	Landed agriculturalist; consolidated over 300 acres via formal Virginia Treasury Warrants.
Material Estate	Heir to a grand New England fortune.	Utilitarian frontier farmstead; documented via agricultural tools, weaving wheels, and a personal library of religious texts.

Conclusion: Restoring the Legacy

By replacing ancestral folklore with verifiable DNA profiles and local land records, this ledger permanently corrects the historiography of Asa Hall. He is restored to his rightful place in history: not as an ornament of an unrelated New England family, but as a true veteran of the American Revolution and an independent pioneer of the Roanoke Valley.

The evidence—genetic, scholarly, legal, and material—converges on a single, coherent life. That life was not defined by inherited wealth or aristocratic lineage, but by deliberate migration, military service, land acquisition, and the steady accumulation of a modest, working farmstead on the Appalachian frontier.

This 2026 revision honors the foundation laid in the 2000 study. It transforms early scholarly intuition into a documented, genetically verified, and permanently archivable record.

Sources and References

- **DeGidio, Wanda Ware.** *Lineage of the Descendants of John Hall of Rhode Island*. www.hallfamilyname.com.
- **Hall, Roderick A.** *A Slice of History: A Story of a Hall Family of America*, Version 1.2 (2000).
- **Kegley, Mary B.** *Virginia Frontier: The Beginning of the Southwest*. p. 611.
- **Montgomery County, Virginia.** Land grant records (1785, 1803, 1815).
- **Montgomery County, Virginia.** Will Book 6, pp. 325–326 (1841 appraisalment and dower allotment).
- **National Archives and Records Administration.** Revolutionary War pension file for Asa Hall (granted June 17, 1833).
- **Y-DNA testing results** — direct male-line Hall descendants; haplogroup G-M201/G2a.

Archival and Distribution Notes

This document is intended for long-term preservation across multiple platforms:

- **GitHub repository** — master Markdown source for version control and future updates.
- **Internet Archive (Archive.org)** — public-facing PDF for permanent, searchable access.
- **Lulu / IngramSpark** — print-on-demand volumes for family distribution.
- **Regional archives and historical societies** — bound print copies for institutional custody.

For maximum permanence, the raw GEDCOM file, high-resolution document scans, and this manuscript should be stored in the GitHub repository alongside the published formats.